

Speaker 1 [00:00:06] First of all, welcome.

Speaker 2 [00:00:09] Welcome.

Speaker 1 [00:00:10] [Partner's name] may have mentioned it. I've done it with her before.

Speaker 1 [00:00:18] We have talked about it before. We are curious about your views on romantic relationships and we think your experiences and perspectives will enrich our project. I have to ask you again, would it be okay for you to record this?

Speaker 2 [00:00:33] That would be fine.

Speaker 1 [00:00:35] Okay. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:38] [25-30].

Speaker 1 [00:00:40] How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:44] [0-5] years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:46] Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:48] No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:50] Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2 [00:00:53] It was just me and my girlfriend. We have been in the same house for [0-5] years. But my father got sick, I came home to support him. Her mother is alone and she goes to support her mother. So we are together [1-5] days a week. [1-5] days we are not together, we have settled ourselves into a tempo.

Speaker 1 [00:01:14] I see. What is your main source of income? I mean your job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:19] I am a [occupation]. I do [job].

Speaker 1 [00:01:27] What would you like us to call your partner? Girlfriend, wife, lover.

Speaker 2 [00:01:32] Lover is appropriate.

Speaker 1 [00:01:34] So can you tell me the story of how you met and how your relationship started?

Speaker 2 [00:01:44] The story of how we met was like this, I had a close friend, I hadn't seen him for a while and then I went to him. On the way there they said, there is a chair, we will take it, we will carry it, we will take it from one place to another, etc. I said it would be okay. We met for the first time when we were carrying that chair. After that, staying at home was bothering me at that time. I was uncomfortable because of the situations at home. That's why I was living such a life with my hand in my bag, constantly going to my friend and staying at his place, bouncing from there to another place, bouncing from there to another place. When corona or something came in between, I started to spend some time at their house. So we became intimate over time, and it turned into a relationship with [partner's name].

Speaker 1 [00:02:36] So how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:02:49] It's pretty good. When I look at the relationships around me. I don't think there are many people around me who have many relationships. When I think about it, I always see our relationship as a quality relationship and a promising relationship. Both parties respect and love each other. We are very different people, when you look at it, we are nothing alike. But somehow we fill our gaps.

Speaker 1 [00:03:31] Well, for example, you said we are good, we have quality. Could you elaborate on this a bit more, what makes you think that it is good or high quality?

Speaker 2 [00:03:41] First of all, we are in a trusting relationship. We do not go out of a certain framework of mutual love and respect. First of all, this is important. I don't know, I believe that sometimes there is a level and once you drop that level, you can't catch it again. Sometimes certain things come out of your mouth and once they come out, you can't take them back. We haven't experienced such things. I mean, there are arguments between us. I'm more of a dirty, slovenly person and he's a more organized person who likes to be clean. Even on very basic issues about how one lives one's life, we are not very similar. Of course we have arguments too. But I don't remember sleeping or waking up sulking with [partner's name]. We argue and she's probably right. I've been an ass, but we work it out. Because what I mean by quality is that we are constructive, I mean being constructive at all times, under all circumstances, I think it turns it into a better quality and promising relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:04:58] I see. So how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:05:04] This is the [0-5th] one.

Speaker 1 [00:05:07] How would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous partner?

Speaker 2 [00:05:13] I would rate it much better. In my first relationship my girlfriend's family was very conservative. We couldn't stay together, she wouldn't even stay at her friend's house. For a while it was fine to be with her during the day, to live modestly, and to have more fun with my friends at night. But then, as she opened up, it started to bother me a bit that I was having so much fun at night. Because I was very free and she was not free at all. That relationship didn't work. In my second relationship, my partner was as free as me. She was even freer than me. It went well for a while but it didn't work out for the same reasons. Sorry, it didn't work out for the opposite of the same reasons. This is my third relationship. In this relationship, the person in front of me is much stronger, independent, more aware, more joyful than in previous relationships. That's why it feels much stronger than previous relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:06:29] What makes a relationship high quality for you?

Speaker 2 [00:06:35] As I said, I think the fact that it is promising, that it does not go beyond a certain framework of respect and love, being constructive at the end of the day. Everybody argues. No one is perfect in life, everyone has a flaw. My flaw is maybe a big flaw when you look at it. She also has flaws. When I look at them, they also have big and small flaws. But the point that I call quality, in my opinion, is to be constructive, to be constructive all the time. Because being constructive brings tolerance. In fact, it's all about how much you want to solve them that takes

you from problems, which is impossible to live a life without problems, to solutions. And I think this is through being constructive.

Speaker 1 [00:07:30] I see. So, according to you, can we say that it is important to have a promising future in close relationships, to maintain a framework of love, respect and to be constructive?

Speaker 2 [00:07:40] Right?

Speaker 1 [00:07:43] So for example, how do you know when you have a promising, loving, respectful, constructive relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:07:53] How do I know that this is happening in a relationship. I mean, I'm [25-30] now, I'm almost in my 30s because we're getting older. I think there's a threshold after 25. People start to worry after they reach a certain place in life. I mean, we have grown up. Our body doesn't work as beautifully and comfortably as it used to. From now on, we will follow the real consequences of every step we take in life until the end of our lives. Therefore, with a consciousness and an awareness of what you want in this life, what you will be proud of doing, what you will be satisfied with doing, you want to achieve it as soon as possible, you want to look for it. In other words, they don't want to waste time. At that point, I am already talking about the issue of promising the future, I mean I am such and such a person, I have such and such an expectation from my life. Apart from that, being respectful, being a lover is something I see every day, 7 days a week. It's something I see every day when I call, when I talk to her, when she looks me in the eye. How you deal with problems, your communication, how you communicate while dealing with these problems. All of these things define the boundaries of this love, this respect.

Speaker 1 [00:09:30] I see, and when was the last time you felt like this in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:09:41] I think I always feel like this. Without seeing a future without love, without respect. I mean, of course people think that after arguing, after having an argument, after experiencing something big, we had such a threshold, we are in our [0-5th] year. Somewhere around one and a half, half of it, or even two, it became clear how different we were. It turned out that we were no longer sure whether our expectations from life were compatible or not, and so on. But again, we didn't stop trying to solve it, we didn't stop being constructive. I had hesitations, so did [partner's name]. It is true that we still have hesitations from time to time, but we will continue to change and develop. I would never have given up hope and continued to be in this relationship at that time. I don't know, that's why I feel like this 90% as my general mood.

Speaker 1 [00:10:51] I see. So what are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:10:58] Trust is very important. Once trust is gone, it cannot be restored. There is that frame of respect that I mentioned that once it falls to that level, it will never recover. Trust is very important, support is important, sincerity is important. I don't know, for example, knowing that my partner will support me in my difficult day, knowing that I will support him/her in his/her difficult day are very important things. I mean, it's a very difficult thing to know that you can lean on someone, it's a very important thing. It's very important to be able to have fun with the other person. It's important to feel like yourself with them. If someone makes you feel closer to the person you want to be, that's also very important. If you are funnier, more affectionate or more etc. than you normally are, then I really believe that the other person can bring out your true qualities, the qualities you want to bring out, the qualities that are closer to the person you want to be. These are important for me.

Speaker 1 [00:12:16] So what is love according to you?

Speaker 2 [00:12:21] I mean, I think that love in general is something that is somewhat obsessive. I mean, in the end, what we call love is an abnormal condition that makes your body come to a certain state by releasing certain hormones under certain conditions, based on the authority given by science. When you experience this, the decisions you make are not very rational. The emotion you feel is also not very much. But I approach happiness in a very similar way. Right now, for example, I am not happy. There is no reason for me to be happy. But I live satisfied with my life. So I can't be happy all the time, I don't need to be happy all the time. You can't be happy anyway. The same goes for love. It's also a state. It comes and goes, but it's not like what I call passing. It's not like it comes and goes again. When you are sharing things with the other person, when you are gaining experience, from time to time you become happy, for example, like I just mentioned. When you are happy, you enter a certain state. I don't believe in this. You can't live in love all the time, you can't live happily all the time, you can't secrete those hormones all the time and stay in a certain state. There is no need for it. I think love and happiness are a bit similar in that regard.

Speaker 1 [00:14:02] Okay, so how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:14:07] I mean it is very important. If we see what we call love as a motivation at some point, for example, people don't do anything without motivation. I don't even go to work without being motivated and I'm not even okay with working in a job that I won't be motivated. So a relationship that I'm not motivated, I don't go to the theater, I don't go to the cinema, I don't even do the things I love, I have to be motivated.

Speaker 1 [00:14:39] How do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:14:47] Communication. Communication necessarily comes at moments in one's life when sacrifices have to be made. As I mentioned, knowing that you can get support from someone when the time comes, knowing that you are not alone is also very important and valuable. From time to time, there are moments of sacrifice, whether small or big. In moments of sacrifice, it already comes out. Apart from that, communication is something that you can understand even by looking into someone's eyes when you are at a very close distance with them, when you are in and out of the same bed.

Speaker 1 [00:15:29] So what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:35] I have two challenges on my agenda right now. Maybe one of them. One is my addictions. The second one is that I am more disorganized when we live in the same house. And the third one is that [partner's name] doesn't have much of a social life outside of me.

Speaker 1 [00:16:19] So is there anything else you would like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:16:23] No

Speaker 1 [00:16:28] Do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2 [00:16:29] We do from time to time.

Speaker 1 [00:16:30] How often do these fights happen?

Speaker 2 [00:16:37] Not very often, I think. Maybe twice a month.

Speaker 1 [00:16:47] What do these fights mostly about?

Speaker 2 [00:16:50] They are about the two problems I just mentioned. The third one is not included. You may not see it as a fight. The first two of the problems I cannot solve between us are

our main problems, the third one is an indirect problem, but the first two are pretty much. I don't think we have any problems except these two, I don't think we have any arguments except these two, and these two are not that something like this is happening and we are fighting. These are already knots on our relationship, waiting to be untied, and if they cannot be solved, maybe it will be a relationship that will not continue.

Speaker 1 [00:17:37] I see. So how do you resolve and resolve these fights?

Speaker 2 [00:17:49] Constructively, I guess. By convincing each other that we can change and improve things in a mutual way.

Speaker 1 [00:18:07] So apart from being constructive and mutual communication, what are other ways of maintaining your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:18:17] I don't quite understand the question.

Speaker 1 [00:18:20] For example, you can resolve your fights by being constructive or by communicating with each other? And what are the other ways to maintain your relationship other than that?

Speaker 2 [00:18:31] Other ways to maintain our relationship, so we can solve these problems. This is the main thing that will solve everything anyway. If we can't get to this point, the sincerity that comes from the fact that there is an effort being made at this point, that there is a time, energy being spent at this point, energy being spent. These are the most optimum solutions. If these do not happen, it is like a trial process, can it be solved or not? If there is already hope that it can be solved, then it is already sustainable. If it comes to the point that it cannot be solved, then we talk to each other. It can be said that I want to draw such an intermediate path in life, it would be sad, but in the end we are adults. Everyone is free to live how they want to live. We cannot continue in that way. But there is nothing else but to solve these things like this. If we can't solve this, I think this relationship won't work, there's no other way. I don't think there is any other way other than solving.

Speaker 1 [00:19:54] Okay. So would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:20:00] I would say so.

Speaker 1 [00:20:02] And why?

Speaker 2 [00:20:06] I've learned so many things, I've experienced so many things. In life, for example, I was a bit lazy, I was very much into comfort zone and after I met [partner's name], [partner's name] is the opposite of what I just said. I don't know, she was a very responsible, mature woman who had been studying and working on her own for a long time, taking care of her family. She impressed me a lot. Thanks to this relationship, I have provided a motivation to go out in life and pay a price, to provide something, to do something, to put your hand under the stone. If it wasn't for [partner's name], I think I wouldn't have been able to provide that motivation or I would have had a lot of difficulty. That's why I think about how I have a different comfort, a different airbag that I am motivated by this relationship, this relationship, this relationship that I have learned. That's why I have provided almost everything for [0-5] years, and I have progressed a lot in my life in these [0-5] years. I think it's safe to say that I owe everything to this relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:21:40] So for example, you said that it played a role in you taking responsibility. Can you give an example of that?

Speaker 2 [00:21:48] She was working, she was coming home, she was tired, we were doing other things on top of that. After that, you know what it was like? You know that problem I mentioned in my previous relationships, something like that. One is working and the other is not. It leads to a breakup. For example, if one of them is very happy at work and goes to work happily, while the other is very unhappy, the happiness of one starts to sink into the other at some point. Things like that. I saw that the girl was struggling so much. I said, if I don't struggle at least as much as her, this will never work. That's exactly what she made me feel, and not as an ultimatum or anything like that. I felt it and I sat down and I started moving, I started moving.

Speaker 1 [00:22:59] So did this relationship change you? And in what way did it change you?

Speaker 2 [00:23:08] Yes, a lot. As I just mentioned, I became seriously motivated. I dared to take what I wanted out of life, I dared to pay a price for a little while, I dared to take the plunge. And from the moment I started pushing myself, everything flowed. So I just needed a push. I got that push and as I said, I am a very different person compared to [0-5] years ago. My side has changed almost 180 degrees. You can also write it like this, I put a lot of responsibility on me, and as I was able to handle other responsibilities, my self-confidence increased, my love and respect for myself also increased. I can say that I am much more at peace with myself than I am.



Speaker 1 [00:24:08] I see. And did your partner change during that relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:24:18] She changed too. For example, she was working in a job that she was unhappy with. For example, when I was learning this job, there was a period when I worked almost without earning any money. For example, she supported me financially. When she was very unhappy with her job, I was earning good money. She resigned from her job by both benefiting from my vision and trusting me, and [partner's name]'s self-confidence is low, for example, we knew for how many years that she wanted to resign from her job, we were talking. I think we have a lot to teach each other because we are both very different people. [Partner's name] has also changed, I mean she has changed a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:25:19] Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:25:28] I mean, the problems we are trying to solve are big problems, not small problems, we both have such problems in our lives. So now we are focused on solving these problems. For example, the first problem I mentioned is such a big problem that whether [partner's name] is in my life or not doesn't change the fact that this problem is hard for me to solve and how big it is. I had this problem with me in my past life and in my life before [partner's life] and I couldn't solve this problem in my life before her. That's why my sense of trust in our relationship is not one hundred percent. After all, I need to solve a problem that I didn't know how to solve before, that I couldn't succeed, so that this relationship can continue. So of course we have question marks. We will do our best, we need to do our best, but other than that, I feel safe in a relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:26:36] For example, how do you feel safe? Can you give an example? What makes you feel safe?

Speaker 2 [00:26:46] I can say that I am not alone in this life. I have [partner's name] behind me. In good times, in bad times, in difficult times, in a much, much better time, [partner's name] is always there for me. No matter what I'm going through, I can call her, I know she will pick up my phone, I can share my most sincere and heartfelt feelings, good and bad. While doing these things. Someone I know I won't be judged indiscriminately makes me feel safe.

Speaker 1 [00:27:27] Got it, I'm going to show you something like a scale on the screen, but it's okay if you can't read it. If I ask you out loud, can't you see it like this, if I ask you that my partner usually really listens to me, on a scale of 1 being not true at all and 9 being completely true, what would your answer be?

Speaker 2 [00:27:50] Between 1 and 9?

Speaker 1 [00:27:51] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:27:55] [Partner's name] will listen to me. I would say 8 I guess.

Speaker 1 [00:28:03] So if I ask if my partner is generally sensitive to my needs, again between 1-9.

Speaker 2 [00:28:11] I would say 8 again.

Speaker 1 [00:28:15] You just answered 8 to the question that my partner really listens to me. So why not a 7 or a 9?

Speaker 2 [00:28:25] I never say the ceiling in such scale questions because we don't know the ceiling. That's why I didn't give my full. I gave what I could give because I thought she is really listening to me and trying to understand me.

Speaker 1 [00:28:50] I got it. So the second question I asked was that you gave 8 for being sensitive to my needs. Again, in the same way, did you give because of the ceiling?

Speaker 2 [00:29:00] Yes, for the same reason. In fact, I would even call it a nine. We could call it a nine, but I guess that wouldn't be a lie. A couple of months ago, I had scabies. Like, what a difficult time I've had. I mean, I work in a social job. I had to go to concerts in the summer months when I need to earn the most money, I lost my job, and I spent a lot of money to get better. [Partner's name] took care of all my needs. Whatever support I needed, she supported me. So I think I can give nine on this issue. Because I don't have any question marks because we lived the concept of health in sickness with [partner's name]. That's why I can say nine.

Speaker 1 [00:29:51] Okay? I hope you don't mind me asking. If this is a sensitive subject for you, feel free to say so. But I would like to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker 2 [00:30:06] It's not as much as it used to be because we have separate houses, so we spend half and half different time. If we are together three days a week, let's say at least 2 to 6 times a week.

Speaker 1 [00:30:32] How satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:30:39]. At some point things got into a routine. The fact that it has become a routine takes a little bit of excitement out of it, no lie. I am not unhappy but I think it could be more exciting.

Speaker 1 [00:31:11] I see. How satisfied are you with your relationship in general? On a scale of 1-7, 1 being completely dissatisfied, 7 being completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:31:27] 6

Speaker 1 [00:31:36] So for example if 0 is not satisfied at all and 10 is completely satisfied, what would your relationship satisfaction be?

Speaker 2 [00:31:47]. When I think about our current problems and so on, I would definitely not give less than 7. I think I can give 8.

Speaker 1 [00:32:06] So why 8 and not 7 or 9?

Speaker 2 [00:32:14] I mean I'm happy with my relationship actually. I deduct one point for perfection, we got down to 9, and one point for not being able to socialize [partner's name] as much as I would like. I am a very extroverted person. She is a very introverted person. That's why it started to make me feel a little bit like I have [partner's name] in my life when I'm with [partner's name], or I have [partner's name] out of my life. I can't bring it all together, I'm not happy with that situation. I deducted one point from there, that's 8. Apart from that, there are problems we can't solve and so on. But these problems that we can't solve are not problems caused by my dissatisfaction. For example, we have problems with cleanliness. I mean, it is true that it should be clean without argument or exception. I know I can't say anything about that either. That's why 8. 7 why not? The fact that the problems that need to be solved in the middle are not coming with the other person's problems but a little bit with my problems. I think it jumps from 7 to 8.

Speaker 1 [00:34:01] Yes, we are about to finish now. I will tell you what we talked about in this hour. I mean I will summarize. You met [0-5] years ago, you met by going back and forth at your friend's house. In general, you describe your relationship as good and high quality. You think you have a stronger relationship compared to your previous relationships. The important things for you in your relationship are that it is promising, that it is based on love, respect and that it is constructive. Apart from that, there are some difficulties in your relationship and you are trying to solve them. You believe that he is taking you to a better place. You think he or she is taking more responsibility and leading you to a more organized life. Likewise, you think that you are influencing your partner for the better. Other than that, you are generally satisfied with your relationship. Is there anything else you would like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:35:15] I guess not. It sounded like a lot when you read it like that. For example, I just listened to [partner's name]'s perspective in my head and I thought that she would have given more unhappy answers and now I feel sad. But as I said, I think the fact that the problems that need to be solved are caused by me, based on me, makes me happier than her in this relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:35:44] I see, okay, that's what I said and I don't think you have anything to add. So now before we finish I would like to talk to you about how we are going to handle the data. This is a research project. We're trying to be as transparent as possible. So we want to know which option of sharing the data is the most appropriate for you. So the first option is to share some excerpts from the transcript of our interview. None of this transcript will contain information that can identify you. This way, our anonymous interview transcript can also be read by other research subjects. The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a bit bolder, is to share the interview transcript completely stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details about you, i.e. anonymized. In this option, there is a small chance that someone who knows you well will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down the choices of who they believe you are among your colleagues. I would like to emphasize again that no sensitive information will be shared. Which of these two options would you prefer?

Speaker 2 [00:36:49] Which one did [partner's name] prefer, do you remember?

Speaker 1 [00:36:54] I think [partner's name] preferred two but she agreed to have your age, occupation and how you met removed.

Speaker 2 [00:37:06] Okay, we can do it the same way for me then.

Speaker 1 [00:37:10] You have the second one with the same information removed.

Speaker 2 [00:37:15] That's right.

Speaker 1 [00:37:15] Got it. Thank you again for participating.

Speaker 2 [00:37:19] Thank you.